

ADRIAN SUTTON

WAR HORSE ORCHESTRAL SUITE

for orchestra

FULL SCORE



War Horse Orchestral Suite (2014)

- *Devon at peace*
- *First gallop*
- *Crossing the channel*
- *Emilie's theme*
- *The charge*
- *Joey and Albert reunited*

The National Theatre's immensely successful production of Michael Morpurgo's book, ***War Horse***, proved to be a turning-point in Adrian's theatre music career. His work would now be heard by over 8 million people in 11 countries. Audiences are still clamouring for more performances.

It is a classic tale of love lost and found. At the beginning of World War One, young men are being enlisted and farm-horses sequestered to the Cavalry. Joey is one such horse and is taken from his farm in Devon, where he is much loved by young Albert. Joey is soon caught up in enemy fire and ends up serving on both sides. Albert cannot forget him and, though still not old enough to enlist, embarks on a treacherous mission to find him and bring him home.

The brief for the play's music was to combine an English folk idiom with more symphonic material that could underpin the larger set pieces, such as the charges on the Front. John Tams provided adaptations of folk songs, whose themes Adrian then wove into the orchestral score. In order to widen the scope and reflect both sides in conflict, he also incorporated sounds and ideas from German symphonic repertoire.

For the 2016 ***War Horse: The Story in Concert*** at the Royal Albert Hall, Adrian rescored the entire show's cues for live symphony orchestra. War Horse Orchestral Suite is a selection of highlights from that score. The scenes are taken slightly out of the order they originally appear in the play, but they follow its general narrative arc.

1. Devon at peace

This accompanies the opening scene to the play. Joey's theme is played on a trumpet, with its immediate connotation of military gallantry. There is a hint of darkness in the dissonant intervals, a sense of the strife to come. The strings soon settle the mood, soothing and shimmering, and members of the woodwind quote the folksong 'Only Remembered', which would become an anthem for the play.

2. First gallop

Young Albert braves his first gallop on Joey, coursing through the fields around the farm. With bows bouncing off the string and the wind section pulsing, the music is alive with both the trepidation and excitement of the young boy, as well as depicting Joey at majestic full stretch. Had he wings he would be airborne within seconds. Adrian brings Joey back to a canter at the end.

3. Crossing the Channel

War has been declared, villagers from all over the country have been drafted and horses sequestered. As the new recruits cross the English Channel, the horror of what awaits begins to dawn.

The strings and woodwind rumble in a dark, low register to emphasise the dread and foreboding. Trombones echo a folksong, 'The Scarlet and The Blue'. Before, this had been sung in high spirits as people naively welcomed the adventure of war and the promise of derring-do. Here, as the Normandy cliffs loom on the horizon, it sounds hollow, even funereal.

4. Emilie's theme

Emilie is a young French girl who ends up caring for Joey behind French lines. Flutes and high violins immediately set a tender, at times exotic tone, with the harp casting its light over the scene. The strings remind us of Joey's past in Devon, now with unsettled harmonies as he paces his new surroundings.

Adrian channels here the writing of Swiss composer Arthur Honegger, whose symphonies he had always admired. It helps lend a different European accent to the scene. Joey might have found a new home but Devon feels far away.

5. The charge

Galloping music returns, this time laden with sinister brass and the snap of the snare drum as the cavalry charge the barbed wire of No man's land. This is one of the iconic moments from the play, realising the thrill and drama of the charge while also conveying its cost. There would be devastating casualties.

Joey's theme is referenced on shrill trumpets, underlaid by rhythms from 'The Scarlet and The Blue'. All mayhem breaks loose and a final, fatal charge is launched.

6. Joey and Albert reunited

After their harrowing adventures, Albert finally finds Joey and takes him back home. The music takes us full circle to the beginning of the suite, with the soft strings welcoming Joey back to the farm and a quiet clarinet playing the folksong from before. Touchingly simple, it conveys both the quiet wonderment of a homecoming with the knowledge that nothing can ever be the same.

Instrumentation

2 Flutes, 2nd doubling piccolo
2 Oboes
2 Clarinets (A, Bb), 2nd doubling bass clarinet
2 Bassoons

4 Horns in F
3 Trumpets in C
2 Tenor trombones
Bass trombone
Tuba

Timpani

Percussion - 2 players:
Glockenspiel, snare drum, bass drum,
piatti, suspended cymbal

Harp

Strings

Duration: ca. 15 minutes

This is a transposing score

Print rights in this score and its parts are copyright © Cordafonia Music 2018
(a trading name of Audio Integer Limited)

Other publishing rights in this work are administered by
BMG Rights Management (UK) Limited

All rights reserved. No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system or transmitted in any form, or by any means, without the prior permission in writing of the copyright holders, or as expressly permitted by law.

Visit www.cordafoniamusic.com for full information

WAR HORSE ORCHESTRAL SUITE

ADRIAN SUTTON

1. Devon at Peace

Tentative ♩ = 56

Flute 1.2

Oboe 1.2

Clarinet 1.2 in B $\flat$

Bassoon 1.2

Horn 1.2.3.4 in F

Trumpet 1.2 in C

Trumpet 3 in C

Trombone 1.2

Bass Trombone

Tuba

Timpani

Glockenspiel

Snare Drum

Harp

Violin 1

Violin 2

Viola

Violoncello

Double Bass

Tentative $\text{♩} = 56$

in B $\flat$

1. solo

mp

p

p E $\flat$, F $\sharp$, G $\sharp$, A $\sharp$
B $\sharp$, C $\sharp$, D $\sharp$

Tentative $\text{♩} = 56$
con sord.

pp con sord.

pp

A

7

poco rit. a tempo

Fl. 1.2

Ob.1.2

Cl. 1.2

Bsn.1.2

Hn.1.2.3.4

Tpt. 1.2

Tpt. 3

Tbn.1.2

B. Tbn.

Tba.

Timp.

Glock.

Sn. Dr.

Hp.

A

poco rit. a tempo

Vln. 1

Vln. 2

Vla.

Vc.

Db.

20 poco rit. . **C** a tempo

Fl. 1.2

Ob. 1.2

Cl. 1.2

Bsn. 1.2

Hn. 1.2.3.4

Tpt. 1.2

Tpt. 3

Tbn. 1.2

B. Tbn.

Tba.

Timp.

Glock.

Sn. Dr.

Hp.

Vln. 1

Vln. 2

Vla.

Vc.

Db.

espress.

mp

p

pp

non div.

div.

pp

p

mp

pp

p

mp

pp

mp

This musical score page contains measures 27 through 32. The instrumentation includes woodwinds (Flute 1 & 2, Oboe 1 & 2, Clarinet 1 & 2, Bassoon 1 & 2), brass (Horn 1, 2, 3, & 4, Trumpet 1 & 2, Trumpet 3, Trombone 1 & 2, Baritone Trombone, Tuba, Timpani, Glockenspiel, Snare Drum, Harp), and strings (Violin 1 & 2, Viola, Violoncello, Double Bass). Measure numbers 27, 28, 29, 30, 31, and 32 are indicated at the top of each measure group.

- Measures 27-28:** Flute 1 & 2 play a triplet of eighth notes (G4, A4, B4) starting in measure 27, marked *mf*. Other instruments are silent.
- Measure 29:** Clarinet 1 & 2 enter with a triplet of eighth notes (F#4, G4, A4), marked *mp*. Bassoon 1 & 2 play a sustained chord of D3 and F#3, marked *mf*.
- Measures 30-31:** Horns 1, 2, 3, & 4 and Trumpets 1 & 2 play a triplet of eighth notes (B3, C4, D4), marked *mf*. The bassoon continues its chord. The string section enters with a triplet of eighth notes (G2, A2, B2), marked *mp*.
- Measure 32:** All instruments continue their respective parts. The harp plays chords Eb, F#, G#, Ab and Bb, C#, D#. The double bass has a pizzicato marking.

33

Fl. 1.2

Ob. 1.2

Cl. 1.2

Bsn. 1.2

Hn. 1.2.3.4

Tpt. 1.2

Tpt. 3

Tbn. 1.2

B. Tbn.

Tba.

Timp.

Glock.

Sn. Dr.

Hp.

Vln. 1

Vln. 2

Vla.

Vc.

Db.

D

mf

mf *espress.*

mp

mp

mp

mp

mp

arco

div.

non div.

5

1. dolce

39

Fl. 1.2

mp

Ob. 1.2

Cl. 1.2

Bsn. 1.2

Hn. 1.2.3.4

pp

Tpt. 1.2

1.

p

5

Tpt. 3

Tbn. 1.2

B. Tbn.

Tba.

Timp.

Glock.

Sn. Dr.

Hp.

E♭, F♯, G♭, A♭
B♭, C♭, D♭

p

E♭, F♯, G♯, A♭
B♭, C♭, D♭

V

dolce

mp

div.

p

Vln. 1

dolce

mp

div.

p

Vln. 2

V

sul G

p

Vla.

p

Vc.

p

Db.

46 attacca

Fl. 1.2

Ob. 1.2

Cl. 1.2

Bsn. 1.2

Hn. 1.2.3.4

Tpt. 1.2

Tpt. 3

Tbn. 1.2

B. Tbn.

Tba.

Timp.

Glock.

Sn. Dr.

Hp.

Vln. 1

Vln. 2

Vla.

Vc.

Db.

p

mf

pp

ppp

flautando

sul G flautando

pizz.

arco

attacca

2. First Gallop

Agitato ♩ = 130

[illegible]

58

Fl. 1.2

Ob. 1.2

Cl. 1.2

Bsn. 1.2

Hn. 1.2.3.4

Tpt. 1.2

Tpt. 3

Tbn. 1.2

B. Tbn.

Tba.

Timp.

Glock.

Sn. Dr.

Hp.

Vln. 1

Vln. 2

Vla.

Vc.

Db.

[illegible]

70

Fl. 1.2

Ob. 1.2

Cl. 1.2

Bsn. 1.2

Hn. 1.2.3.4

Tpt. 1.2

Tpt. 3

Tbn. 1.2

B. Tbn.

Tba.

Timp.

Glock.

Sn. Dr.

Hp.

Vln. 1

Vln. 2

Vla.

Vc.

Db.

Glock

To Sus Cym

ff

mp

mf

f

gliss.

tutti non div.

f

arco

74

Fl. 1.2

Ob. 1.2

Cl. 1.2

Bsn. 1.2

Hn. 1.2.3.4

Tpt. 1.2

Tpt. 3

Tbn. 1.2

B. Tbn.

Tba.

Timp.

Susp. cym.

Sn. Dr.

Hp.

Vln. 1

Vln. 2

Vla.

Vc.

Db.

pointed sound near rim

mf *p* *<mf* *p* *<mf* *sim.*

Susp. cymbal

f

To Cyms.

mp

*E*₄, *F*₄, *G*₄, *A*₄
*D*₄, *C*₄, *B*₃

f *3*

sim. *3*

f *3*

div. *3*

4

[illegible]

[illegible]

[illegible]

91

Fl. 1.2 *sf* 7

Ob. 1.2 *sf*

Cl. 1.2 *ff* 7 7

Bsn. 1.2

Hn. 1.2.3.4

Tpt. 1.2 *a2* *mp*

Tpt. 3 *mp*

Tbn. 1.2 *mp*

B. Tbn. *ff* *mp*

Tba. *mp*

Timp.

Susp. cym. *ff* To Cym.

Sn. Dr. To B. D.

Hp. *gliss.* E $\flat$, F $\sharp$, G $\sharp$, A $\sharp$
D $\sharp$, C $\sharp$, B $\flat$ *mp* *f*

Vln. 1 *sf* *loco* *largamente sost.*

Vln. 2 *sf* *largamente*

Vla. *sf* 3 3 3 3 3

Vc. 3 3 3 3 3

Db. *f*

[illegible]

[illegible]